

image, which is fixed in size. Nest the table within a single-cell table with a cell padding of 1 pixel (or more for a thicker border) and a background of the colour you want for the border.

```
<table border=0 bgcolor=#000000
cellpadding=1 cellspacing=0>
<tr><td>
<table border=0 bgcolor=#FFFFFF
cellpadding=0 cellspacing=0>
<tr><td>Content here</td></tr>
</table></td></tr></table>
```

Re-use images

If an image is repeated through the site, use the same file across all pages so that it needs to be downloaded only once—the browser's cache takes care of this. If you use similar images, break them into static and changing parts so you can reuse the static part of the image.

Smaller images

The size of an image will be smaller if you use a 256-colour palette. GIFs are generally smaller than JPEGs, but JPEGs offer better quality when using lots of colours as on photographs. With smaller images, use distinct edges and crisp colours.

Almost all imaging tools optimise images by saving them with a palette of only those colours used in the image. Some applications let you choose how many colours to use in the image. It then replaces colours not fitting in that palette with the nearest match, thus reducing the image size.

Avoid too many animated graphics. A lot of them together are unpleasant to

the eye and also take longer to download as compared to simple images.

Stylise your site

Use a style sheet for your site to add consistency and reduce page size. You won't have to explicitly define many font and paragraph tags. Avoid using inline styles—this is as good as using HTML tags—except for special cases. Use a single CSS file that has all the style definitions. Once a person visits a page, the browser will use the file from the cache for the rest of the pages.

De-script-ion

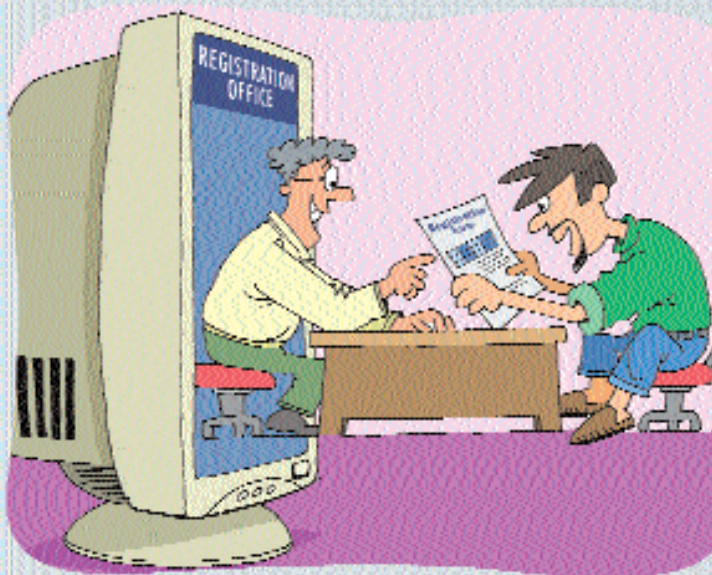
As with external style sheets, try and push all JavaScript (JS) into one or several external JS files. Re-used code such as that for rollovers, menus, validation, etc can easily be separate functions in a single file. Again, the file will have to be downloaded only once and will be used from the cache henceforth. So try to use scripts that are as generic as possible so that they work smoothly with all pages.

Less jazz, more speed

The lesser jazz on a page, the faster it loads. Animations and rollovers affect the size and number of files the browser has to download. Another aspect usually overlooked is DHTML items such as menus that show and hide themselves. Though hidden away, they add a lot of code to the page, increasing the size considerably. Use these wisely and limit the number of such hidden blocks to a minimum.

GETTING ONLINE

Select wisely. Check out the features and deals offered by different services before you register with free hosting services



Free Hosting

The Web offers free software utilities and other services that let you design, upgrade and maintain your site

Storage space

Server space becomes a constraint as you start building up your site. You have to ask yourself the question "How much space will I actually need?" HTML pages take up very little space and if you follow the optimisation techniques discussed above you will save on a considerable amount of space while uploading images.

Choose a free hosting service that offers you upwards of 10 MB of space. For instance, Freeserver.com offers you 12 MB of free

space while Yahoo Geocities offers you 15 MB.

File size limits

Hosting your pages on free servers across the Internet would gulp down the bandwidth of the free service provider. Hence, most of them restrict the size of the files that can be uploaded. For example www.freeservers.com offers you a 256 KB file size limit, which is the maximum as far as we have seen. Choose a free hosting provider that would offer better file size limits. Freeservers.com also gives its free registrants a maximum bandwidth of 512 MB per month.

FTP access

For maintaining your site



Interactive Mobile Finder, Mobile Comparison, Reviews, Buyers Guide, SMS Special, Prices

Mobile

www.zdnetindia.com/mobile